



CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Power BI for Professionals

Data preparation, modeling, DAX, dashboards, KPI design, storytelling, and stakeholder reporting

PARTNER LEARNING SERIES

Learn how to turn raw business data into trustworthy Power BI models, reusable measures, decision-ready dashboards, and stakeholder narratives.

CareerSense Partners • analysts • business professionals • data beginners

CareerSense Learning Series • careersenseai.com/resources

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Handbook

Learn how to turn raw business data into trustworthy Power BI models, reusable measures, decision-ready dashboards, and stakeholder narratives.

What each chapter contains

Each chapter follows the same learning rhythm used across the CareerSense Academy series: a concise introduction, learning objectives, plain-English concepts, CareerSense examples, professional habits, common mistakes, quick revision notes, practice questions, and hands-on exercises.

PARTNER PROMISE The examples are designed to prepare you for real CareerSense Partner assignments. Do not memorize terminology. Learn to create useful work products: audits, reports, prototypes, dashboards, campaigns, strategies, and decisions.

Recommended practice approach

- Read the relevant chapter before starting the matching Partner assignment.
- Use CareerSense or a safe sample environment to practise whenever possible.
- Keep evidence: screenshots, notes, links, spreadsheets, queries, designs, or metrics.
- Document assumptions and limitations instead of hiding uncertainty.
- Finish each chapter by completing at least one hands-on exercise.

CONTENTS

What You Will Learn

Chapter	Topic
01	Power BI Workflow and Business Questions
02	Power Query and Data Cleaning
03	Data Modeling and Relationships
04	DAX Measures
05	Dashboard Design and KPI Selection
06	Interactivity and Drill-Down
07	Publishing, Refresh, and Governance
08	CareerSense Capstone: Business Dashboard

Closing the book: quick revision sheet • glossary • professional habits • 20-question quiz • answer key • next steps.

CHAPTER 01

01

Power BI Workflow and Business Questions

Strong BI begins with business questions, not charts. Define what decision the report should support, who will use it, and at what grain the data should be modeled.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Understand the Power BI stack
- Translate questions into metrics
- Plan a report
- Recognize data grain

Core idea

Strong BI begins with business questions, not charts. Define what decision the report should support, who will use it, and at what grain the data should be modeled.

Professional perspective

Power BI workflows typically move through data connection, transformation, modeling, DAX measures, visualization, validation, publishing, and iteration.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A CareerSense dashboard could answer which tools drive activation, which cohorts retain, and where users abandon.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Understand the Power BI stack.
- Translate questions into metrics.
- Plan a report.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of power bi workflow and business questions?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to power bi workflow and business questions using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 02

02

Power Query and Data Cleaning

Power Query creates repeatable data preparation steps. Avoid manual spreadsheet cleanup that cannot be reproduced.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Import common sources
- Change data types
- Handle nulls
- Merge and append tables

Core idea

Power Query creates repeatable data preparation steps. Avoid manual spreadsheet cleanup that cannot be reproduced.

Professional perspective

Document assumptions about missing values, duplicates, and business definitions.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Prepare sample CareerSense registrations, service usage, plan, and assignment tables for analysis.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Import common sources.
- Change data types.
- Handle nulls.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of power query and data cleaning?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to power query and data cleaning using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 03

03

Data Modeling and Relationships

A star schema separates measurable events from descriptive dimensions. This usually produces clearer DAX and more reliable filtering.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build star schemas
- Understand fact and dimension tables
- Manage relationships
- Avoid ambiguous models

Core idea

A star schema separates measurable events from descriptive dimensions. This usually produces clearer DAX and more reliable filtering.

Professional perspective

Relationship direction and cardinality matter.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Model usage events as a fact table with user, date, service, plan, and cohort dimensions.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Build star schemas.
- Understand fact and dimension tables.
- Manage relationships.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of data modeling and relationships?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to data modeling and relationships using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 04

04

DAX Measures

Measures calculate dynamically based on report filter context. Prefer measures over unnecessary calculated columns for aggregations.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Create measures
- Understand filter context
- Use CALCULATE
- Build ratio metrics

Core idea

Measures calculate dynamically based on report filter context. Prefer measures over unnecessary calculated columns for aggregations.

Professional perspective

Always define denominators carefully.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Create measures for active users, interview completion, ATS usage, partner assignment completion, and conversion.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Create measures.
- Understand filter context.
- Use CALCULATE.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of dax measures?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to dax measures using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 05

05

Dashboard Design and KPI Selection

Dashboards should support scanning, comparison, trend detection, and investigation.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Choose appropriate visuals
- Build hierarchy
- Avoid chart clutter
- Create KPI cards

Core idea

Dashboards should support scanning, comparison, trend detection, and investigation.

Professional perspective

Use charts because they answer a question, not because they are visually available.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Build an executive CareerSense overview with activation, retention, service usage, conversion, and plan mix.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Choose appropriate visuals.
- Build hierarchy.
- Avoid chart clutter.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of dashboard design and kpi selection?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to dashboard design and kpi selection using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 06

06

Interactivity and Drill-Down

Interactivity should help users move from overview to explanation. Too many controls create confusion.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use slicers
- Create drill-through
- Add tooltips
- Manage bookmarks

Core idea

Interactivity should help users move from overview to explanation. Too many controls create confusion.

Professional perspective

Design default views for the most common decision.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Allow leaders to drill from total usage into service, plan, cohort, institution, or date.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Use slicers.
- Create drill-through.
- Add tooltips.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of interactivity and drill-down?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to interactivity and drill-down using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 07

07

Publishing, Refresh, and Governance

A professional BI solution needs ownership, refresh expectations, permissions, and metric governance.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Understand workspaces
- Plan refresh
- Manage permissions
- Document metric definitions

Core idea

A professional BI solution needs ownership, refresh expectations, permissions, and metric governance.

Professional perspective

Different dashboards should not calculate the same KPI differently.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Create a CareerSense metric dictionary and define who can access student, partner, and institutional data.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Understand workspaces.
- Plan refresh.
- Manage permissions.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of publishing, refresh, and governance?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to publishing, refresh, and governance using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 08

08

CareerSense Capstone: Business Dashboard

Build a Power BI dashboard from a CareerSense sample dataset. Include acquisition, activation, product usage, plan, partner progress, and outcome metrics.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Clean data
- Build a model
- Create DAX measures
- Present recommendations

Core idea

Build a Power BI dashboard from a CareerSense sample dataset. Include acquisition, activation, product usage, plan, partner progress, and outcome metrics.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Deliver the PBIX or screenshots, metric dictionary, five insights, and five recommended actions.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Clean data.
- Build a model.
- Create DAX measures.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of careersense capstone: business dashboard?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to careersense capstone: business dashboard using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CLOSING THE BOOK

Course Summary

You have worked through the professional foundations of power bi for professionals. The purpose of this handbook is not to make you fluent in vocabulary; it is to help you complete real work with stronger judgment, structure, evidence, and communication.

**PROFESSIONAL
TAKEAWAY**

CareerSense Partners should be able to explain not only what they did, but why it mattered, what evidence supported it, what trade-offs existed, and what measurable action should happen next.

Power BI for Professionals - Quick Revision Sheet

Topic	Remember
Power BI Workflow and Business Questions	Understand the Power BI stack
Power Query and Data Cleaning	Import common sources
Data Modeling and Relationships	Build star schemas
DAX Measures	Create measures
Dashboard Design and KPI Selection	Choose appropriate visuals
Interactivity and Drill-Down	Use slicers
Publishing, Refresh, and Governance	Understand workspaces
CareerSense Capstone: Business Dashboard	Clean data

Glossary

Term	Plain-English meaning
DAX	Expression language used to create measures and calculations in Power BI.
Star schema	Data model with central fact tables connected to descriptive dimensions.
Filter context	The active set of filters used when a DAX measure is evaluated.
Outcome	A measurable change in user, customer, or business behavior.
Metric	A quantitative measure used to monitor performance or progress.
Hypothesis	A testable statement about what change is expected and why.
Stakeholder	A person or group affected by or able to influence an initiative.
MVP	The smallest trustworthy version that tests an important assumption.
KPI	A key performance indicator tied to an important objective.
Iteration	A cycle of building, measuring, learning, and improving.
Trade-off	Choosing one benefit or priority while accepting a cost elsewhere.
Evidence	Observed information that supports or challenges a decision.
Prioritization	Deciding what deserves attention and resources first.

20-Question Practice Quiz

1. What is one core principle from 'Power BI Workflow and Business Questions'?
9. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Power BI Workflow and Business Questions' in a real assignment?
2. What is one core principle from 'Power Query and Data Cleaning'?
10. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Power Query and Data Cleaning' in a real assignment?
3. What is one core principle from 'Data Modeling and Relationships'?
11. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Data Modeling and Relationships' in a real assignment?
4. What is one core principle from 'DAX Measures'?
12. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'DAX Measures' in a real assignment?
5. What is one core principle from 'Dashboard Design and KPI Selection'?
13. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Dashboard Design and KPI Selection' in a real assignment?
6. What is one core principle from 'Interactivity and Drill-Down'?
14. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Interactivity and Drill-Down' in a real assignment?
7. What is one core principle from 'Publishing, Refresh, and Governance'?
15. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Publishing, Refresh, and Governance' in a real assignment?
8. What is one core principle from 'CareerSense Capstone: Business Dashboard'?
16. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'CareerSense Capstone: Business Dashboard' in a real assignment?
17. Why should recommendations be tied to evidence?
18. What is the difference between an activity and an outcome?
19. Why should assumptions and limitations be documented?
20. What makes an assignment deliverable useful to leadership?

Answer Key

1. A strong answer should explain understand the power bi stack and connect it to an observable decision or result.
9. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
2. A strong answer should explain import common sources and connect it to an observable decision or result.
10. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
3. A strong answer should explain build star schemas and connect it to an observable decision or result.
11. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
4. A strong answer should explain create measures and connect it to an observable decision or result.
12. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
5. A strong answer should explain choose appropriate visuals and connect it to an observable decision or result.
13. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
6. A strong answer should explain use slicers and connect it to an observable decision or result.
14. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
7. A strong answer should explain understand workspaces and connect it to an observable decision or result.
15. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
8. A strong answer should explain clean data and connect it to an observable decision or result.
16. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
17. Evidence separates a useful recommendation from an unsupported opinion.
18. An activity is work performed; an outcome is the change produced by that work.
19. Documenting assumptions makes uncertainty visible and allows reviewers to judge the strength of the conclusion.
20. A useful deliverable is clear, evidence-based, actionable, appropriately scoped, and tied to an owner or next decision.

CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Keep Building

You now have a working foundation in power bi for professionals. Use this handbook as a reference before and during your Partner assignments. Professional capability grows when you repeatedly turn concepts into useful outputs, receive feedback, and improve your judgment.

NEXT STEPS

- Choose the CareerSense Partner assignment most closely related to this handbook.
- Review the relevant chapter before beginning.
- Complete the assignment with traceable evidence.
- Ask for feedback on both the result and your decision process.
- Add the finished work to your Partner portfolio where permitted.

**CAREERSENSE
PARTNER
LEARNING PATH**

Learn → Apply → Document → Review → Improve → Lead.

More CareerSense learning resources

careersenseai.com/resources